

Title: Need help understanding "wave management" and why ADCs don't want me to "ever" hit a minion

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

(Keep in mind, I play pretty casually and I'm only Iron level.) When I play with my ADC friend, we don't have this issue. She prefers that I help her decrease minion health so she can get the last hit as many times as possible and clear waves quickly. We play generally pretty aggressively and push hard bot lane. This might be bc we've gotten used to games where our jungle hardly ever comes bot to gank, and we don't like losing lane. We frequently win like this and get As or Ss on our champions, so I haven't had reason to see an issue with the way we play.

When I play with other ADCs, they literally go beserk if I touch minions at all. But what else am I supposed to do early game? If it helps, I play Morgana, so I really can't heal, only shield and the rest of my abilities are damage-focused. The root and drain combo does wonders. So if there aren't any opportunities to root or damage to opponents, am I just supposed to sit around and keep an eye out on their jungle coming and my ADCs health to shield?

These ADCs also don't want to push the lane. My last game, the ADC did not want me to touch the minions at all, and I didn't unless they went some other lane, and what ended up happening was we lost the lane and hadn't even touched their first turret at all. We still ended up winning because mid and top lane were very good and pushed mid, but I don't see the point of not clearing the minions and allowing the other team to essentially just "have" the turret, especially when the ADC wasn't really getting any kills either and was essentially feeding the opponents by not falling back when their health was really low.

If anyone can help me see the benefits I am clearly missing, that would be greatly appreciated.

EDIT: Thank you all for your advice!! Some of you in one comment thread are being really rude for no reason though, and it really discourages people from learning. Don't bring the infamous chat toxicity to a space where people are genuinely trying to gain an understanding of the game.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 124]

Are you thinking about what you're doing when you hit the minions or casting w on the wave off cd regardless of lane state?

If we are Jinx Morgana vs Tristana and Naut, we are in danger if we push up and black shield isn't going to stop everything.

Most ADCs don't know what to do and are likely just getting mad to get mad but if you are forcing the push you have to make sure it makes sense.

[Comment 2 | Score: 53]

they can freeze the wave, if you constantly push, jg will come and gank and even if you ward, you're still dead because it's often too late once you see them. You should only push when you're trying to crash the wave and recall most of the time. Pushing to their side often means they have a longer lane to run you down once jg comes. Your side of the map is safer than their side

[Comment 3 | Score: 23]

There are times when pushing or freezing can be beneficial. For example if my flash is down, my jungler is going to gank top and I think the enemy jungler is bot side. I do not want the wave to push.

This will force me to over extend in the lane if I want minions. Good players will punish you for this if you are weaker.

I want to push out the wave if I can hit their tower and the minions will die before they get back. I also want to push so I can have the first opportunity to make a move around the map, help jungler, or get to objective.

If you don't understand these things and your ADC is trying to set up a freeze and you break the freeze that can be frustrating. It's possible your ADC also doesn't understand wave states or situations and are making the wrong decisions. I prefer my supports to let me as an ADC handle wave manipulation and help me around level 1-2-3, stop wave from crashing when I'm not there and pushing with me when it makes sense.

[Comment 4 | Score: 16]

ADC wants to keep the wave in a certain spot. You hitting it makes that much harder. Notably, they should not be allowing it to hit the tower at all if they're doing this.

Freezing the wave and stopping it from pushing is really important sometimes. If you constantly shove aggressively a few things happen:

? Enemy laners can safely farm under their turret and without a hook or dive you have very little chance of killing them.

? Your adc can't safely farm under turret, and they can potentially be denied lots of farm and xp if the enemy laners are stronger.

? You're at risk of getting ganked while you're constantly shoved under their tower.

? You will have a very hard time denying the enemy laner minions or experience while they're safe under tower.

Generally, you want to push with a purpose. Push for level 2 first. Push for a plate and/or recall. etc. Just pushing constantly is how you get frustrated when jg and mid keep ganking your lane and you die on repeat, and then the enemy laners stand behind your minion wave and zone you off. The adc wants to walk up and hit the minions, but if it's Draven and Thresh and you push and it gets frozen near the enemy tower your adc is just kind of fucked for that wave. Either walk up and dodge for their life while they farm, or starve until the freeze breaks. Morgana helps with that a bit with the shield, but there's still a high chance you just get run down and killed after you E the Thresh hook. Bad wave management and the consequences that come with it makes life actual hell for an adc, and they don't have the fallbacks that supports have where they can still do things while they're behind.

For Morgana specifically, you benefit a lot from the wave being frozen near your tower as well, because if you're relatively safe to do so you can just camp the bushes while the wave is frozen in front of your tower. If they walk up you can zone them with W or walk at them for a Q*. Post 6 walking at them and just hitting R and not dying before the stun goes off is just free kills sometimes if they're far enough from their turret.

*If your adc is willing to back you up. Some adcs just won't fight ever at any point in the game unless they're swooping in to get the last hit on a champ at 10% life. Those adcs are trash and untrustworthy.

[Comment 5 | Score: 12]

There are times where I want the wave to sit on our side of the lane, allow my support to step up into a bush and just threaten them if they walk up. Make it risky to come touch the wave, and get poked out or all-inned if they do.

As a player who's played both roles for many years, the basic rule (unless pinged otherwise by your ADC) is that the ADC manages the wave, and the support supports the ADC in doing so. If I want to hold the wave and ping you to stop hitting, just stop hitting and allow your ADC to manage the wave. If they want your help they will ping "push."

Just remember that a large part of the support role is to get this bum-ass ADC to late game safely, so if you go against what they want on wave-state it doesn't help them do their job.

Side note, perma pushing is fine but there will come a time where the players are better and will punish you for it. But in Iron, keep at it because you're less likely to get punished for it!